

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, November 12, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the October 22, 2025 City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

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Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept the minutes of the November 6, 2025 City Council meeting.

Voice vote:
Koloski – Abstain
Greenrose – Abstain
Limoges - Yes
Matteau – Yes
Zutter – Yes
Hemingway – Yes
Hayden – Yes
O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 7-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Girard gave a big congratulations to the girls varsity stevens soccer team.

Hometown holiday liftoff lighting of the tree will take place Friday, November 28th.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

Manager Bates was approached about a possible purchase of city owned property on Grissom Lane looking for a right of way on City property. Conesus is to bring to next meeting.

Councilor Koloski reminds the council in the past proper of steps you have to make to make sure there is no other interest

Valley Regional easement signed – conduit will go in.

Visitor center – December 1st discussion of next steps will be brought to council in December.

North and Main- last day November 17th

Water sewer rate studies- RFP is out for the website, deadline is December 5th.

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Manager Bates asks that all Election signs be removed please.

Manager Bates informed the council of 13 Edgewood street now being a legal case and manager will keep everyone updated.

MS1 tax 2025 filed last week.

Director Hamilton MS1 report total value of city setting final numbers have been sent to DRA. Explains further numbers.

Short Discussion followed.

Councilor O’Hearne brought concerns of main street lighting as it is so dark.

Manager Bates responds to councilor O’Hearne that lights will be looked into.

Councilor Koloski adds that the current pot hole paving is receiving positive praise. Also that the project downtown and the inspection process; A difference in the inspections, receiving good feedback.

APPOINTMENTS TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Steering Committee for EPA Multi-Purpose Grant

Assistant Mayor Matteau Currently held by Councilor Hayden. Should we ask Cogswell to wait.

Mayor Girard suggested moving Cogswell in January.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Christopher Cogswell to Seat 5 of the Steering Committee for EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway –Yes

Hayden – Yes

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O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint G. Michael Sanborn to Seat 2 of the Steering Committee for EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Voice vote:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Elks Education Fund Trustee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to re-appoint Vicki Corliss to the Elks Education Fund Trustee

Voice vote:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard opened the forum at 6:50pm

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Mike Tetu Ward 1- see handout given to council. Charter petitions revote of charter November 2026 state. Asking to get on the agenda.

Chief Chamberlain fire chief thanks Councilor Limoges for repairs on the FD heating system and donated time.

Elizebeth Cram ward 1- invite and council to the pie sale for friends of the library on November 25 12pm-6pm anyone in the public can bake for it.

Closed citizens forum 6:55pm

OLD BUSINESS

NEW BUSINESS

Request for Restoration of Involuntarily Merged Lot: 9 First Street

Mr. Ford no city town county can merge expect on account with owner. Parcel In question originally 6 parcels. Owner of the property country bumpkin realty. Was once 6 lots. The property can only be in to two lots due to the size of the lots.

Motion to Restore Involuntarily Merged Lots

The Claremont City Council hereby recognizes as valid the request to restore involuntarily merged lots known as Tax map 121-64, owned by Country Bumpkins Real Estate LLC, currently consisting of .31 acres, and hereby approves the partial restoration of said involuntarily merged lots. This restoration will result in two lots of record, one of approximately 6,000 square feet of vacant land, and one of approximately 7,500 square feet of improved land.

AYES _____

ABSENT _____

NAYS _____

ABSTAIN _____

CERTIFICATION

I, Jamie L. DeRosa, the undersigned officer, hereby certify that the foregoing Motion was adopted by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, at a meeting, duly noticed, and held on Wednesday, November 12, 2025.

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Jamie L. DeRosa, Clerk to the Council

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to approve the Motion to Restore Involuntarily Merged Lots

Roll call:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

Ice and Snow Removal Policy Presentation

Assistant Director Wadleigh presented. See PowerPoint.

Councilor Greenrose inquired on sand that is available to public, salt sand or sand.

Assistant Director Wadleigh explains DPW prioritize downtown and school. Detail on route.

Assistant mayor Matteau ask on behalf of a constituent if the crosswalks will be cleared in a timely manner without banks in front.

Assistant Director Wadleigh responds yes side walk machine goes through after the road was cleared.

Councilor Koloski was asked by an elementary student if schools could name snow plows.

Resolution 2026-21 Use of Fund Balance for CDA Roof Project - Public Hearing

Manager Bates – CDA came looking to borrow fund balance, this will be paid back to the City.

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Manager Bates will look at the interest figures. Further impact she does not believe will affect cash flow.

Councilor Zutter inquires of when that would come back to the city.

Manager Bates still waiting for plans to come back from the roofer, end of January. CDA project.

Councilor Zutter voices concern of not having a date with the money being paid back.

Manager Bates nothing saying I must transfer money tomorrow we can check and see if a date can be confirmed before we release funds

Mayor Girard finishing up plans contractor has been out working on. Further damage to the building. Not a need for the money yet but a place holder for covering the roof costs.

Manager Bates explains everything done so far, they have the money to cover nothing to what has been expensed. Inspection had good result. Trying to turn this around quickly before snow the load.

Mayor Girard explains 80/20 percentage we are responsible to pay the bill upfront. Cash flow reimbursements are making sure we did not go beyond the total cost of the project.

Councilor Koloski feels he wants to vote no on this. Tax payer ultimately could be on the hook for the entire project.

Manager Bates explains the grant is already granted. This will delay on the CDA project.

Councilor Koloski will support but hesitant. We are not doing this again.

Mayor Girard states based on the city planners face, she agrees that this should not happen again.

Councilor Hayden wants to confirm we will have a timeline for the project.

Manager Bates will get that out before the next meeting

RESOLUTION 2026-21

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MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

USE OF FUND BALANCE – CDA ROOF PROJECT – 56 OPERA HOUSE SQUARE

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS, the Claremont Development Authority (CDA) has determined a need for working capital to support an NBRC reimbursement grant to repair the roof at 56 Opera House Square, and has requested Two Hundred Thousand Dollars (\$200,000) for said purpose; and

WHEREAS, the Claremont City Council wishes to see this project completed in a timely manner;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, to raise and appropriate a sum of Two Hundred Thousand Dollars (\$200,000) from the General Fund Balance to be transferred to the CDA (with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the CDA will return the full amount of said capital to the City's general fund balance upon project completion and receipt of final reimbursement; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. (2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 12th day of November 2025, in the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

AYES _____ ABSENT _____

NAYS _____ ABSTAIN _____

CERTIFICATION

I, Jamie DeRosa, the undersigned officer, certify that the foregoing Resolution was adopted by the City Council of Claremont, New Hampshire, at a meeting, duly noticed, and held on November 12, 2025.

Jamie DeRosa
Clerk to the Council

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A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2026-21.

Roll call:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges – Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-23 Private Hangar Lease Agreement Approval – Public Hearing

Chief Chamberlain explains resolution 2026-23. Presented to the airport board. Lease agreement.

Chief Chamberlain explains automotive reality land is what the rent is for at fair market value. Director Hamilton reviewed. Property tax on the hanger building rent is strictly for the land.

Mayor Girard inquires where the funds do go from the lease.

Chief Chamberlain responds, in the airport is where it stays.

RESOLUTION 2026-23

**THE CITY OF CLAREMONT AND AUTOMOTIVE REALTY, LLC TO ENTER INTO
A LEASE AGREEMENT AT THE CLAREMONT MUNICIPLE AIRPORT**

WHEREAS, the Claremont Municipal Airport continues to support local economic development, aviation growth, and community engagement through its adherence to the current Airport Master Plan; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Christian Gomes, representing Automotive Realty, LLC, has proposed the construction of a 75’ x 50’ private aircraft hangar on airport property, located directly adjacent to the Griffcon LLC Private Hangar, which was completed earlier this year; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gomes has retained Stantec Engineering for site plan development and has worked collaboratively with the Airport Manager throughout the planning process; and

WHEREAS, all required documentation has been submitted to the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA), which has confirmed the project’s eligibility for construction; and

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WHEREAS, the proposed lease agreement has been prepared in accordance with existing airport lease structures, reviewed by the City’s Assessing Department to ensure fair market value, and approved for compliance by the New Hampshire Bureau of Aeronautics; and
WHEREAS, the lease agreement provides a 20-year term, expiring in 2045, with an annual rent of \$2,250, increasing by \$375 every five years; and
WHEREAS, this project aligns with the goals and objectives of the Claremont Municipal Airport Master Plan and will contribute positively to the sustainability and continued development of the airport;
NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that the Claremont City Council hereby approves the construction of a private hangar by Automotive Realty, LLC, and authorizes the City Manager to execute the associated lease agreement on behalf of the City of Claremont.

Dated this 12th day of November 2025, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

AYES	_____	ABSENT	_____
NAYS	_____	ABSTAIN	_____

CERTIFICATION

I, Jamie DeRosa, the undersigned officer, certify that the foregoing Resolution was adopted by the City Council of Claremont, New Hampshire, at a meeting, duly noticed, and held on November 12, 2025.

Jamie DeRosa
Acting Clerk to the Council

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2026-23.

Roll call:
Koloski – Yes
Greenrose – Yes
Limoges – Yes

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Matteau – Yes
Zutter – Yes
Hemingway – Yes
Hayden – Yes
O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-24 Washington Street Supplemental Appropriation – Public Hearing

Manager Bates explained in April of 2025 the former city manager signed a contract in added labor costs. 21 thousand dollars.

Councilor Zutter inquires if this will affect tax rate.

Manager Bates no tax implication.

Councilor Koloski would like to amend.

Councilor Greenrose agrees and will amend.

Mayor Girard speaks on frustration and will be voting no.

Councilor Koloski will be voting no.

Manager Bates asks how the council would like the city to pay the invoice.

Mayor Girard responds roads.

RESOLUTION 2026-24

Use of Fund Balance - Washington Street

WHEREAS the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the “City Council”) approved funding for the paving of Washington Street in FY25; and

WHEREAS the signed contract included \$21,150 in added labor costs above what was previously appropriated by Council;

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BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council, after public hearing duly noticed, that it hereby raises and appropriates the amount of \$21,150 from unassigned general fund balance to cover the added costs associated with the 2025 Washington Street Project;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the city manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 12th day of November, 2025 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

AYES _____

ABSENT _____

NAYS _____

ABSTAIN _____

CERTIFICATION

I, Jamie L. DeRosa, the undersigned officer, hereby certify that the foregoing Resolution was adopted by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, at a meeting duly noticed and held on November 12, 2025.

Jamie L. DeRosa, Clerk to the Council

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept resolution 2026-24.

Roll call:

Koloski – No

Greenrose – No

Limoges – No

Matteau – No

Zutter – No

Hemingway – No

Hayden – No

O’Hearne – No

Girard – No

Motion carried 0-9

COMMITTEE REPORTS

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EPA- Councilor Hayden – closed to federal shutdown, standstill for the stack coming down.

Airport – Mayor Girard – lease, weather station, runway closed.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski – airport sign as you go down Sullivan and going up airport hill on city land. Thoughts of restoring or replacing that sign.

Councilor Koloski – planning board meeting the other night. Less than one minute of a meeting.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

NON-PUBLIC RSA 91-A:3, II (a)

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau to enter a Non-Public Session per RSA 91-A:3, II (a) the motion was seconded by Councilor Greenrose.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway –Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

Council entered a Non-Public Session at 7:56pm per RSA 91-A:3, II (a)

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:55 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

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Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Jamie DeRosa
Acting Clerk to the Council